

WINNERS LAPTOPS

This year was an interesting one for laptops. No longer the apple of the customer's eye, analysts and industry reports still peg laptops as the last remaining bastion of the PC era, not wholly defeated by the smartphone and connected devices boom. We may all love our smartphones and eagerly look forward to the next best flagship, but we still need a laptop to get work done, and in 2016 the laptop held strong and fought back.

For never before in the history of laptops have GPUs been as good as a comparable graphics card for desktops in any given year, but this changed forever in 2016. With its Pascal GPUs launched this year, NVIDIA dropped the "M" on laptop-class GPUs, hailing them to be near identical to the 10-series

desktop cards (albeit at a slower clock speed). So there's almost no difference between scores achieved on the MSI gaming laptop's NVIDIA GTX 1070 GPU's and the NVIDIA GTX 1070 graphics card on desktops. This is no meagre feat, something that restores the consumer's faith that laptops are now capable of more grunt work than before. Great news for the category as a whole.

The trend of miniaturization, or making laptops even more thinner and lighter than last year, obviously continued into this year as well, where Acer unveiled their Switch 7 – claimed to be the thinnest laptop in the world – measuring less than 1 cm at its thickest point, which is again a great sign of dynamism and healthy competition among brands in the laptop arena.

